

DriveOS — What's New

A plain-language guide to the latest changes, so you know what's different and how to use it.

In one sentence

You can now clean up duplicate and junk files across **all** your drives — including external ones — straight from the website, and the desktop app does the work for you automatically. When you're ready, you can permanently delete old quarantined files to actually free up space.

The big changes

1. Cleanup now works on external drives

Before: cleaning up files on an external drive (like a My Book or Seagate) silently failed.

Now: it works on every connected drive. When a file is cleaned up, it moves into a hidden `.driveos-quarantine` folder **on that same drive** — so it stays recoverable, and it doesn't fill up your computer's main disk.

2. Click once on the website — the app does the rest

Before: clicking "Quarantine" on the website queued the job, but nothing actually happened until someone ran a command by hand.

Now: the desktop app checks for approved cleanups about **once a minute** and carries them out on its own. You click on the website, walk away, and it's done shortly after.

3. "Empty Expired" — actually free up space

Quarantined files sit safely for **14 days** in case you need them back. After that, you can permanently delete them to reclaim the disk space.

There's a new **Empty expired** button on the **Quarantine** page that shows how many files are ready (e.g. "Empty expired (37)"). Click it, confirm, and the space is freed for good. *This is the only step that permanently deletes anything — and it always asks you first.*

4. Drives show their real location

Before: every drive showed "Los Angeles" no matter where it actually was.

Now: each computer reports its own location, and its drives show that location automatically. (Your admin sets this once per machine.)

5. The Mac multi-drive freeze is fixed

If you connected several drives to a Mac and hit Scan Now, the app could freeze partway. That's fixed — all your drives scan through reliably now.

6. Remove a drive from the desktop app

Each tracked folder now has a **Remove** button, so you can stop tracking a drive right from the app. *(This only removes it from DriveOS — your files on the drive are untouched.)*

How to actually clean up — step by step

1. **On the website**, go to **Cleanup** (or **Duplicates**) in the sidebar.
 2. Review what it found. Click **Quarantine** on anything you want cleaned up.
 - *Cleanup page:* a **Quarantine** button per recommendation, or "**Quarantine all safe**" at the top.
 - *Duplicates page:* mark the copies you don't need as **Quarantine**, then click **Quarantine N**.
 3. **Wait about a minute.** The desktop app on the machine with those drives picks up the job and moves the files. (The app must be open and the drives connected.)
 4. The files now show on the **Quarantine** page — still recoverable for 14 days.
 5. **To free space for real:** on the **Quarantine** page, click **Empty expired** once items are past their 14 days.
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Good to know

- **Nothing is deleted without you.** Cleanup only *moves* files to quarantine. The only permanent delete is the **Empty expired** button, which always confirms first.
- **Restore anytime within 14 days.** On the Quarantine page, hit **Restore** to put a file back exactly where it was.
- **Keep the desktop app open** while a cleanup runs — it does the actual work. If a drive is unplugged, the job just waits until it's back.
- **Protected files are never touched** — RAW footage, final exports, and project files are off-limits to cleanup, even if you try.

What's NOT changed (so you're not surprised)

- DriveOS still **never uploads your footage** — only file info.
- New drives are **not** found automatically. You still add each one with **Add drive...**
- There's **no auto-delete**. Permanent deletion is always a button you click.